Fluid Mechanics Notes

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1 Introduction and Flow Kinematics

1.1 Streamlines, pathlines and streaklines

A **streamline** is a curve that is locally tangent to the velocity field at every point. This requirement can be expressed as:

$$dx/u = dy/v = dz/w \tag{1.1.0.1}$$

Streamlines can be found by using this relation to establish one or more differential equations.

A **pathline** is the curve obtained by following the trajectory of a single particle over time. To find the pathlines, use this relationship between the derivatives of the position of the particle and the velocity field

$$\frac{d}{dt}\mathbf{x}_{\text{particle}} = \mathbf{u} \tag{1.1.0.2}$$

And integrate with the initial conditions $\mathbf{x}(t_0) = (x_0, y_0, z_0)$ to get

$$\mathbf{x}_{\text{particle}}(t) = \mathbf{x}_{\text{particle}}(t, x_0, y_0, z_0, t_0) \tag{1.1.0.3}$$

A **streakline** is the curve obtained by connecting all fluid particles that will ever pass through a given point in space. The equations for streaklines are obtained in a similar way to those for pathlines

$$\mathbf{x}_{\text{streakline}}(t) = \mathbf{x}_{\text{streakline}}(t, x_0, y_0, z_0, t_0) \tag{1.1.0.4}$$

The important distinction between eqs. (1.1.0.3) and (1.1.0.4) is that t_0 is kept fixed in (1.1.0.3), since we are only considering one particle (the one that is released at t_0). In (1.1.0.4), we vary t_0 to obtain the trajectories of all particles that will ever pass through (x_0, y_0, z_0).

1.2 Lagrangian and Eulerian descriptions

- **Lagrangian:** follows the trajectory of a *specific particle* over time (particle description of motion)

- **Eulerian:** describes the motion of an arbitrary particle *at a particular location and specific instant of time* (field description of motion)

Motivation for the Eulerian description:

The Eulerian approach solves the question: *Given a velocity field* $\mathbf{V}(x, y, z, t)$*; find the acceleration* $\mathbf{a}_p$ *of a fluid particle at* (x, y, z, t)*.*

We start by noting that the instantaneous velocity of the particle is given by the velocity field at (x, y, z, t)

$$\mathbf{u}_p(t) = \mathbf{V}(x, y, z, t) \tag{1.2.0.1}$$

At $t + dt$ the particle will have a new instantaneous velocity

$$\mathbf{u}_p(t + dt) = \mathbf{V}(x + dx, y + dy, z + dz, t + dt) \tag{1.2.0.2}$$

The infinitesimal change in the particle's velocity is given by the chain rule

$$d\mathbf{u}_p = \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x}dx + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y}dy + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z}dz + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t}dt \tag{1.2.0.3}$$

So the total acceleration of the particle is

$$\mathbf{a}_p = \frac{d\mathbf{V}}{dt} \tag{1.2.0.4}$$

$$= \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x}u + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y}v + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z}w + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t} \tag{1.2.0.5}$$

At this point is is useful to introduce the so-called *material derivative*, or *substantial derivative*

$$\frac{D}{Dt} = u\frac{\partial}{\partial x} + v\frac{\partial}{\partial y} + w\frac{\partial}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \tag{1.2.0.6}$$

$$= \frac{\partial}{\partial t} + (\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \tag{1.2.0.7}$$

Which allows us to write the acceleration of the particle as

$$\mathbf{a}_p = \frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} = (\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla)\mathbf{V} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t} \tag{1.2.0.8}$$

The first term represents movement due to convection (the steady part of the flow) and the time derivative term represents the local acceleration due to unsteadiness in the flow. Eq. (1.2.0.8) is the equation used to compute the acceleration of fluid particles in the Eulerian description.

1.3 Kinematics

Fig. 1 illustrates the four types of motion that are possible for a 2D fluid segment. Any time evolution of a fluid segment will be a combination of these four types of motion.

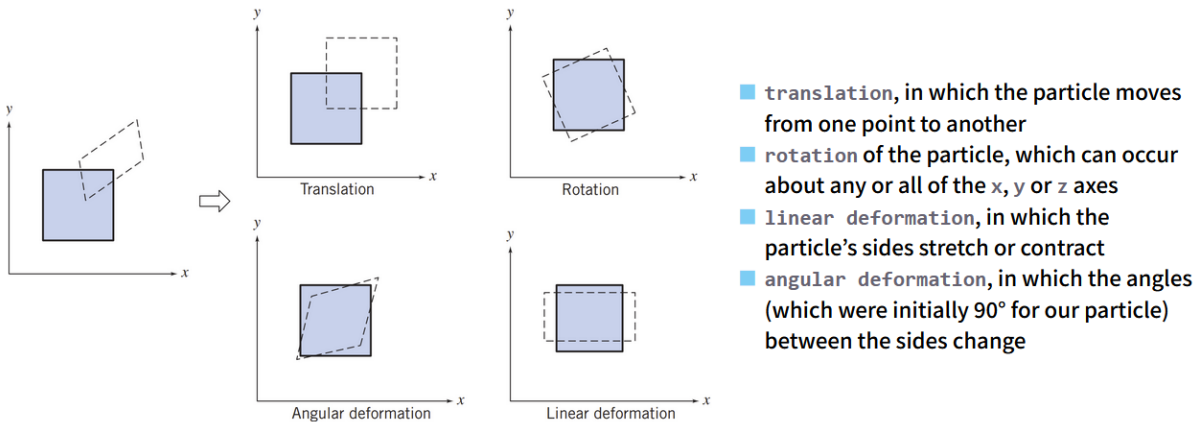


Figure 1: Various types of motion of a 2D fluid segment.

1.3.1 Translation

The translation of an individual fluid particle is connected with the velocity field via eq. (1.2.0.8)

$$\mathbf{a}_p = \frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} = (\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla)\mathbf{V} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t}$$

Since this can be solved to find the translation of an individual particle, it may be used to describe how fluid segments are translated as well. We see that translatory motion depends only on the acceleration of particles in the flow.

1.3.2 Rotation

The rotation of a particle in a flow can be modelled with a vector $\omega = (\omega_x, \omega_y, \omega_<)$ whose components are the angular velocities associated with rotation about the three coordinate axes. Fig. 2 a) and b) show how a square fluid segment undergoes some deformation and rotation during a time interval Δt. The deformation is described by the translation displacements $\Delta\eta$ and $\Delta\xi$ as well as the angular displacements $\Delta\alpha$ and $\Delta\beta$. Note that $\Delta\alpha$ is positive, while $\Delta\beta$ is negative, since we use the convention that counterclockwise rotation is the positive direction of rotation.

Fig. 2 shows

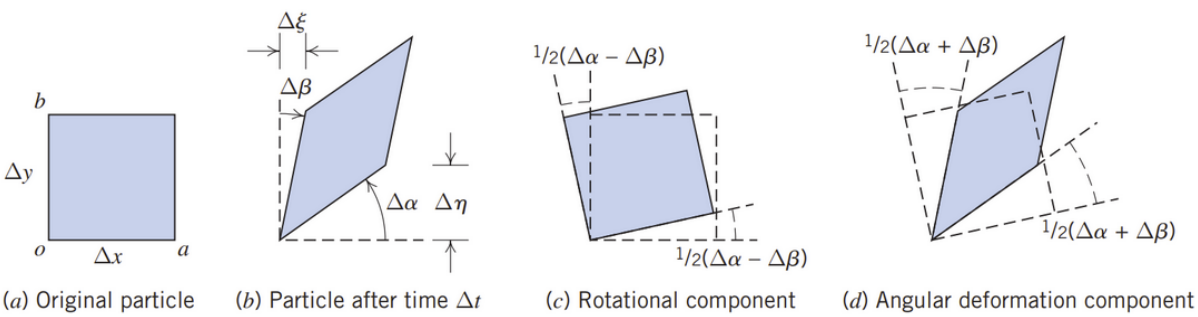


Figure 2

The segment's rigid body rotation (the rotational motion) can be found by taking the average of the two angular displacements, see fig. 2 c). The minus sign in $\frac{\Delta\alpha - \Delta\beta}{2}$ is

due to the fact that we are taking the average in the counterclockwise direction, and the counterclockwise rotation of ob is $-\Delta\beta$.

We will also need to find the translational displacements $\Delta\eta$ and $\Delta\xi$. To do so, we will consider the situation where all of the displacements and angles involved in the problem are small. Then we can Taylor expand the velocity field $\mathbf{V}$ to get

$$V_x(b) = V_x(o) + \frac{\partial V_x}{\partial y}\Delta y \tag{1.3.2.1}$$

So the x-displacement of b will be $\left(V_x(o) + \frac{\partial V_x}{\partial y}\Delta y\right)\Delta t$. To find $\Delta\xi$ we must subtract the displacement of the origin which is $V_x(o)\Delta t$. That leaves us with

$$\Delta\xi = \frac{\partial V_x}{\partial y}\Delta y \Delta t \tag{1.3.2.2}$$

The same argument can be used to obtain

$$\Delta\eta = \frac{\partial V_y}{\partial x}\Delta x \Delta t \tag{1.3.2.3}$$

In our small-displacement approximation, we can write the angular displacements as

$$\Delta\alpha = \frac{\Delta\eta}{\Delta x} \tag{1.3.2.4}$$

$$\Delta\beta = \frac{\Delta\xi}{\Delta y} \tag{1.3.2.5}$$

Leading to the following result:

$$\frac{1}{2}\frac{(\Delta\alpha - \Delta\beta)}{\Delta t} = \frac{1}{2}\frac{\left(\frac{\Delta\eta}{\Delta x} - \frac{\Delta\xi}{\Delta y}\right)}{\Delta t} = \frac{1}{2}\frac{\left(\frac{\partial V_y}{\partial x}\Delta t - \frac{\partial V_x}{\partial y}\Delta t\right)}{\Delta t} \tag{1.3.2.6}$$

To find the angular velocity about the z-axis, we take the limit $\Delta t \to 0$

$$\omega_z = \frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\partial V_y}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial V_x}{\partial y}\right) \tag{1.3.2.7}$$

This is the z-component of the curl of the velocity field (multiplied by a factor of 1/2). The same argument can be applied to fluid segments in the yz- and xz-planes, so we conclude that

$$\omega = \frac{1}{2}\nabla \times \mathbf{V} = \zeta \tag{1.3.2.8}$$

Where we've introduced the vorticity $\zeta = 2\omega = \nabla \times \mathbf{V}$ to get rid of the factor of 1/2.

1.3.3 Angular Deformation

Fig. 1 d) illustrates how the angular deformation component is the sum of the individual angular displacements $\Delta\alpha + \Delta\beta$ (find out where the factor of 1/2 comes from!)

We can repeat the last steps of our previous calculation to see that the total angular deformation in the xy-plane R_{xy} is given by

$$R_{xy} = \lim_{\Delta t \to 0} \frac{1}{2} \frac{(\Delta\alpha + \Delta\beta)}{\Delta t} \tag{1.3.3.1}$$

$$= \frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\partial V_y}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial V_x}{\partial y}\right) \tag{1.3.3.2}$$

And by the same reasoning

$$R_{yz} = \frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\partial V_z}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial V_y}{\partial z}\right) \tag{1.3.3.3}$$

$$R_{xz} = \frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\partial V_z}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial V_x}{\partial z}\right) \tag{1.3.3.4}$$

So angular deformation and rotation is described by the rotation tensor $R_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\partial V_i}{x_j} - \frac{\partial V_j}{x_i}\right)$

1.3.4 Linear Deformation

Linear deformation (deformation that preserves right angles) in the x_i-direction is only possible if $\frac{\partial V_i}{x_i} \neq 0$. This quantity represents the longitudinal strain rate in the x_i-direction. Unlike other types of deformation, linear deformation may lead to changes in volume given by the volume dilation rate

$$\text{volume dilation rate} = \frac{\partial V_x}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial V_y}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial V_z}{\partial z} = \nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} \tag{1.3.4.1}$$

A flow is *incompressible* if the volume dilation is zero $\nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} = 0$.

We see that linear deformation is described by the strain rate tensor $S_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\partial V_i}{x_j} + \frac{\partial V_j}{x_i}\right)$

1.3.5 Tensor Representation of Deformation

To model the deformation that fluid segments undergo, we need to consider the gradient of the velocity field (we have just seen that the derivatives of the velocity field are needed to describe the various types of fluid segment motion).

The gradient of the velocity field is a tensor with the following entries

$$\nabla \mathbf{V} = A_{ij} = \partial_i v_j \tag{1.3.5.1}$$

It is a known result from tensor calculus that *any* tensor can be decomposed into a symmetric and an antisymmetric part. This is easily shown by writing the tensor T_{ij} in a clever way and adding and subtracting the transpose T_{ji}

$$\begin{aligned} T_{ij} &= \frac{1}{2}T_{ij} + \frac{1}{2}T_{ij} \\ &= \frac{1}{2}T_{ij} + \frac{1}{2}T_{ji} + \frac{1}{2}T_{ij} - \frac{1}{2}T_{ji} \\ &= \frac{1}{2}(T_{ij} + T_{ji}) + \frac{1}{2}(T_{ij} - T_{ji}) \end{aligned}$$

It can be shown that the first term is symmetric and the second is antisymmetric. Applying this result to A_{ij}, we see that

$$A_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}(\partial_i v_j + \partial_j v_i) + \frac{1}{2}(\partial_i v_j - \partial_j v_i) \tag{1.3.5.2}$$

Considering the components of the symmetric and antisymmetric parts leads to the revelation that the symmetric part is the angular rotation tensor and the antisymmetric part is the strain rate tensor (both encountered in the previous sections)

$$A_{ij} = \frac{1}{2}E_{ij} + \frac{1}{2}S_{ij} \tag{1.3.5.3}$$

2 From Newton's Second Law to the Navier-Stokes Equations

2.1 Conservation of Mass in an arbitrary Control Volume

Important distinction: For the purposes of this section, a *material volume* is the volume occupied by a specific collection of fluid particles, while a *control volume* is any arbitrary volume whose contents may change over time. In other words, the *material volume* changes as the fluid particles move, while the control volume can be chosen arbitrarily.

Consider a (possible time-dependent) material volume $V(t)$ in a flowing fluid with the fluid density $\rho(\mathbf{x}, t)$. Then the statement of conservation of mass can be expressed as

$$\frac{d}{dt}\int_{V(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x}, t)dV = 0 \tag{2.1.0.1}$$

Now we apply Reynolds transport theorem which makes the following statement (add derivation of this to the mathematics section)

$$\frac{d}{dt}\int_{V(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x}, t)dV = \int_{V(t)} \frac{\partial \rho(\mathbf{x}, t)}{\partial t}dV + \int_{A(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x}, t)\mathbf{b}\cdot\mathbf{n}dA \tag{2.1.0.2}$$

Note that $A(t)$ is the surface of the material volume $V(t)$. Furthermore, $\mathbf{b}$ is the velocity of A and $\mathbf{n}$ is the outward normal vector of A. Applying Reynolds transport theorem to the conservation of mass leads to

$$\int_{V(t)} \frac{\partial \rho(\mathbf{x}, t)}{\partial t}dV + \int_{A(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x}, t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x}, t)\cdot\mathbf{n}dA = 0 \tag{2.1.0.3}$$

Where we have labeled the velocity of the material surface with $\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x}, t)$, to distinguish it from the control surface we will introduce in a moment.

So far, we have been considering a *material volume*. However, a statement of conservation of mass for an arbitrary *control volume* is highly desirable. As a first step, we apply Reynolds transport theorem to the conservation of mass in the control volume V^*

$$\frac{d}{dt}\int_{V^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x}, t)dV - \int_{V^*(t)} \frac{\partial \rho(\mathbf{x}, t)}{\partial t}dV - \int_{A^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x}, t)\mathbf{b}\cdot\mathbf{n}dA = 0 \tag{2.1.0.4}$$

Since the control volume is arbitrary, we can choose V^* such that $V^*(t) = V(t)$ and $A^*(t) = A(t)$ at the specific time t we are considering. Since V^* and V are only instantaneously coincident the time derivative terms $\frac{d}{dt}\int \rho dV$ are not necessarily equal at t. However, the terms that don't contain time derivatives *are* equal at the time t. Combining this knowledge with eq. (2.1.0.4) gives us

$$\int_{V(t)} \frac{\partial \rho(\mathbf{x},t)}{\partial t} dV = -\int_{A(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)\cdot \mathbf{n} dA = \int_{V^*(t)} \frac{\partial \rho(\mathbf{x},t)}{\partial t} dV = -\int_{A^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)\cdot \mathbf{n} dA \tag{2.1.0.5}$$

We can use this to replace the second term in eq. (2.1.0.4)

$$\frac{d}{dt}\int_{V^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t) dV - \int_{V^*(t)} \frac{\partial \rho(\mathbf{x},t)}{\partial t} dV - \int_{A^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{b}\cdot \mathbf{n} dA = 0 \tag{2.1.0.6}$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \frac{d}{dt}\int_{V^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t) dV + \int_{A^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)\cdot \mathbf{n} dA - \int_{A^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{b}\cdot \mathbf{n} dA = 0 \tag{2.1.0.7}$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \frac{d}{dt}\int_{V^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t) dV + \int_{A^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)(\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t) - \mathbf{b})\cdot \mathbf{n} dA = 0 \tag{2.1.0.8}$$

Eq. (2.1.0.8) is the statement of mass conservation for an arbitrary control volume. Note that $\mathbf{u}$, the velocity of the material surface, and $\mathbf{b}$, the velocity of the control surface, must be observed in the same coordinate system (the same frame of reference).

2.2 The Continuity Equation

Let's dive deeper into the material volume mass conservation statement to derive a differential form of mass conservation. Recall Gauss' theorem, which states that *for any C^1 vector field $\mathbf{F}$ defined on an open and bounded subset $V \subset \mathbf{R}^n$*

$$\int_V \nabla\cdot \mathbf{F} dV = \int_A \mathbf{F}\cdot \mathbf{n} dA \tag{2.2.0.1}$$

Where $A = \partial V$ is the boundary of the volume V. Applying Gauss' theorem to the surface integral in eq. (2.1.0.3) gives

$$\int_{V(t)} \frac{\partial \rho(\mathbf{x},t)}{\partial t} + \nabla\cdot(\rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)) dV = 0 \tag{2.2.0.2}$$

Since this must be true for every volume, the integrand must vanish at every point in space, which finally leaves us with

$$\frac{\partial \rho(\mathbf{x},t)}{\partial t} + \nabla\cdot(\rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)) = 0 \tag{2.2.0.3}$$

The first term is the rate of change of the mass density, while the second term is the divergence of the mass density flux. The continuity equation can be re-written using the following product rule

$$\nabla\cdot(\rho\mathbf{u}) = \rho\nabla\cdot\mathbf{u} + (\mathbf{u}\cdot\nabla)\rho$$

And the definition of the material derivative (1.2.0.7)

$$\frac{D\rho}{Dt} = \frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t} + \mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla \rho$$

To obtain the so-called *continuity equation*

$$\frac{1}{\rho}\frac{D\rho}{Dt} + \nabla \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0 \tag{2.2.0.4}$$

Note that for *incompressible* flow the material derivative vanishes and the continuity equation becomes

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0 \tag{2.2.0.5}$$

A flow is incompressible if the density of the fluid is constant throughout the flow. Eq. (2.2.0.5) is sometimes considered the definition of incompressibility, since it is equivalent to the condition that the density is constant.

2.3 Conservation of Momentum in an arbitrary Control Volume

Newton's second law applied to a material volume $V(t)$ looks like this

$$\frac{d}{dt}\int_{V(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)dV = \frac{d}{dt}\int_{V(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{g}dV + \frac{d}{dt}\int_{A(t)} \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{n},\mathbf{x},t)dA \tag{2.3.0.1}$$

Here $\rho\mathbf{u}$ is the momentum per unit volume of flowing fluid, $\mathbf{g}$ is the body force (body forces are forces acting inside the material volume) per unit mass acting on the fluid within V and $\mathbf{f}$ is the surface force per unit area acting on A. $\mathbf{n}$ is the outward normal vector on A. Applying Reynolds transport theorem (2.1.0.2) gives

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{V(t)} \frac{\partial}{\partial t}(\rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t))dV + \int_{A(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)(\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)\cdot\mathbf{n})dA \\ = \int_{V(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{g}dV + \int_{A(t)} \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{n},\mathbf{x},t)dA\end{aligned} \tag{2.3.0.2}$$

The result for an arbitrary control volume is achieved through the same process as for conservation of mass, so I will just quote the result

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{V^*(t)} \frac{\partial}{\partial t}(\rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t))dV + \int_{A^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)(\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)-\mathbf{b})\cdot\mathbf{n}dA \\ = \frac{d}{dt}\int_{V^*(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{g}dV + \int_{A^*(t)} \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{n},\mathbf{x},t)dA\end{aligned} \tag{2.3.0.3}$$

2.4 Tensor Representation of Body and Surface Forces

Body forces are forces that act internally within the volume V without physical contact. Examples are gravity and electromagnetic forces. Body forces are always distributed throughout the volume and proportional to the total mass (or charge, current, etc.)

contained within the volume. Consider the case where the body forces are conservative. In this case, they may be written as the gradient of a potential function Φ

$$\mathbf{g} = -\nabla\Phi, \quad g_i = -\partial_i\Phi \tag{2.4.0.1}$$

The surface forces in the various coordinate directions may be expressed using the stress tensor T_{ij} and surface normal $\mathbf{n}$

$$\mathbf{f} = \mathbf{n}\cdot\mathbf{T}, \quad f_i = T_{ji}n_j \tag{2.4.0.2}$$

It can be shown that the stress tensor is symmetric using Cauchy's tetrahedron argument (add this to the mathematics section if you like suffering).

2.5 Differential form of Momentum Conservation (Cauchy's Equation)

To obtain a differential form of the momentum conservation equation for a material volume, we apply Gauss' theorem on the surface integrals in eq. (2.3.0.3)

$$\int_{A(t)} \rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)(\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)-\mathbf{b})\cdot\mathbf{n}dA = \int_{V(t)} \nabla\cdot(\rho(\mathbf{x},t)\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t))\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{x},t)dV = \int_{V(t)} \partial_i(\rho u_i u_j)dV \tag{2.5.0.1}$$

$$\int_{A(t)} \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{n},\mathbf{x},t)dA = \int_{A(t)} \mathbf{T}\cdot\mathbf{n}dA = \int_{V(t)} \nabla\cdot\mathbf{T}dV = \int_{V(t)} \partial_i T_{ij}dV \tag{2.5.0.2}$$

Substituting this into (2.3.0.3) and collecting the terms in one volume integral gives:

$$\int_{V(t)} \partial_t(\rho u_j) + \partial_i(\rho u_i u_j) - \rho g_j - \partial_i T_{ij}dV = 0 \tag{2.5.0.3}$$

Since this must hold for any volume, the integrand must be zero everywhere

$$\partial_t(\rho u_j) + \partial_i(\rho u_i u_j) = \rho g_j + \partial_i T_{ij} \tag{2.5.0.4}$$

We can rewrite this even further by expanding the :HS

$$\partial_t(\rho u_j) + \partial_i(\rho u_i u_j) = \rho\partial_t u_j + u_j\partial_t\rho + u_j\partial_i(\rho u_i) + \rho u_i\partial_i u_j \tag{2.5.0.5}$$

$$= \rho\partial_t u_j + u_j\left[\partial_t + \partial_i(\rho u_i)\right] + \rho u_i\partial_i u_j \tag{2.5.0.6}$$

The contents of the square bracket are zero, because they are the continuity equation

$$\partial_t\rho + \nabla\cdot(\rho\mathbf{u}) = \partial_t + \partial_i(\rho u_i)$$

Which leaves us with

$$\partial_t(\rho u_j) + \partial_i(\rho u_i u_j) = \rho\partial_t u_j + \rho u_i\partial_i u_j \tag{2.5.0.7}$$

$$= \rho\frac{Du_j}{Dt} \tag{2.5.0.8}$$

So the final result (which is called Cauchy's equation of motion) is

$$\rho\frac{Du_j}{Dt} = \rho g_j + \partial_i T_{ij} \tag{2.5.0.9}$$

2.6 Constitutive Equation for a Newtonian Fluid

A *constitutive equation* for a fluid is an equation that relates stress and deformation in the fluid. To derive the constitutive equation for a Newtonian Fluid (the definition of which will be presented later) we must first express the stress tensor in a form that depends on the strain rate tensor.

2.6.1 Stress Tensor Interlude

Consider a fluid volume at rest. Since the volume is at rest, the stress forces cannot depend on the orientation of the volume (otherwise they could introduce a rotation). The stress must be isotropic and can only be normal to the surface of the material volume. Hence, the stress tensor can be written in the form

$$T_{ij} = -p\delta_{ij} \tag{2.6.1.1}$$

Here p is the thermodynamic pressure. The negative sign is chosen by convention such that the components of $\mathbf{T}$ are positive if they indicate tension, and negative if they indicate compression.

If the fluid begins to undergo motion, it will no longer be at rest and T_{ij} will develop additional dynamic components τ_{ij} because of the viscosity (internal friction) of the fluid. So for a fluid in motion

$$T_{ij} = -p\delta_{ij} + \tau_{ij} \tag{2.6.1.2}$$

This reduces to (2.6.1.1) when the fluid is no longer in motion. The contribution τ_{ij} is called the *deviatoric/viscous stress tensor*. Galilean invariance requires τ_{ij} to be independent of the absolute fluid velocity, which means that it can only depend on the velocity gradient $\nabla\mathbf{u}$. Furthermore, the deviatoric stress tensor can only depend on the symmetric parts of $\nabla\mathbf{u}$ since (by definition!) stresses only develop exist when fluid elements change shape. Hence, τ_{ij} can only depend on the strain rate tensor S_{ij}. We want τ_{ij} to depend linearly on S_{ij} with the condition $S_{ij} = 0 \implies \tau_{ij} = 0$, which is achieved by

$$\tau_{ij} = K_{ijmn}S_{mn} \tag{2.6.1.3}$$

Here K_{ijmn} is some fourth-order tensor that depends on the local thermodynamic state of the fluid and specifies how τ_{ij} depends on each component of S_{ij}. If the fluid medium is isotropic, the relationship between T_{ij} and S_{ij} should be isotropic too, which is only possible if K_{ijmn} is isotropic! This requirement allows us to write K_{ijmn} in the following form

$$K_{ijmn} = \lambda\delta_{ij}\delta_{mn} + \mu\delta_{im}\delta_{jn} + \gamma\delta_{in}\delta_{jm} \tag{2.6.1.4}$$

For some set of scalars λ, mu and γ. These scalars are the source of the dependence of K_{ijmn} on the thermodynamic state of the fluid.

We can go even further: Since T_{ij} is symmetric, τ_{ij} must be symmetric as well. And since S_{ij} is symmetric, this means that the fourth-order tensor K_{ijmn} must be symmetric in i and j, which can only be achieved if

$$\gamma = \mu \tag{2.6.1.5}$$

This leaves us with a much more tractable expression for the deviatoric stress tensor

$$\tau_{ij} = 2\mu S_{ij} + \lambda S_{mm}\delta_{ij} \tag{2.6.1.6}$$

Hence the stress tensor becomes

$$T_{ij} = -p\delta_{ij} + 2\mu S_{ij} + \lambda S_{mm}\delta_{ij} \tag{2.6.1.7}$$

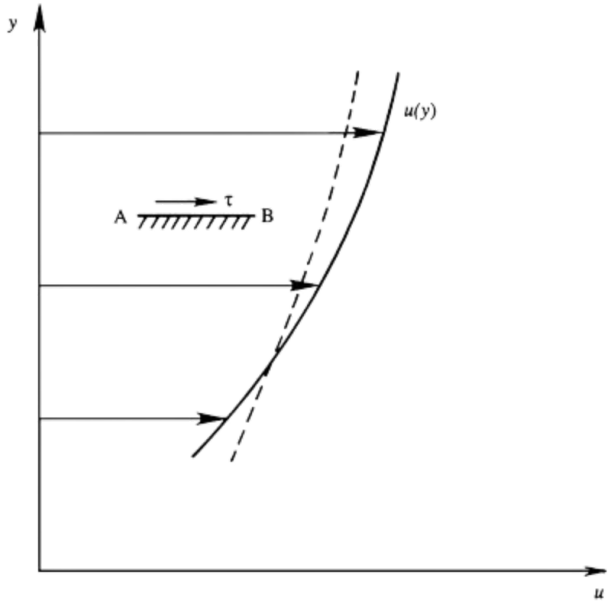


Figure 3: This illustration shows how the shear stress τ in a fluid is approximately proportional to the velocity gradient.

Fig. 3 shows how the magnitude of the shear stress τ in a fluid depends on the velocity gradient. It has been shown experimentally that τ is approximately proportional to the velocity gradient, and that the proportionality factor is the *dynamic viscosity* μ

$$\tau = \mu\nabla\mathbf{u} \tag{2.6.1.8}$$

This is the definition of a *Newtonian Fluid*. We can gain more insight by considering the sum T_{ii}

$$T_{ii} = -3p + 2\mu S_{ii} + 3\lambda S_{mm} \tag{2.6.1.9}$$

$$= -3p + (2\mu + 3\lambda)\nabla\cdot\mathbf{u} \tag{2.6.1.10}$$

This implies that

$$p = -\frac{1}{3}T_{ii} + \left(\frac{2}{3}\mu + \lambda\right)\nabla\cdot\mathbf{u} \tag{2.6.1.11}$$

Now we define the mean pressure as the pressure in absence of shear and stress forces $\bar{p} = -\frac{1}{3}T_{ii}$ and substitute this into (2.6.1.11) to obtain

$$p - \bar{p} = \mu_v\nabla\cdot\mathbf{u} \tag{2.6.1.12}$$

Where we've introduced the *coefficient of bulk viscosity* $\mu_v = \frac{2}{3}\mu + \lambda$. *Stokes assumption* assumes that $\mu_v = 0$ such that $p = \bar{p}$. This is often a good assumption, since μ_v or $\nabla\cdot\mathbf{u}$ tend to be small for most flows.

2.6.2 The Constitutive Equation

Without Stokes assumption, the stress tensor is

$$T_{ij} = -p\delta_{ij} + \tau_{ij} \tag{2.6.2.1}$$

$$= -p\delta_{ij} + 2\mu\left(S_{ij} - \frac{1}{3}S_{mm}\delta_{ij}\right) + \mu_v S_{mm}\delta)ij \tag{2.6.2.2}$$

This is the constitutive equation for a Newtonian fluid. If the fluid is incompressible, $S_{mm} = \nabla \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0$, so the constitutive equation reduces to

$$T_{ij} = -p\delta_{ij} + 2\mu S_{ij} \tag{2.6.2.3}$$

2.6.3 Non-Newtonian fluid

Add the constitutive equation for a non-Newtonian fluid here.

2.7 The Navier-Stokes Momentum equation

To obtain a momentum-conservation equation for a Newtonian fluid, we substitute the constitutive equation (2.6.2.2) into Cauchy's equation of motion (2.5.0.9)

$$\rho\frac{Du_j}{Dt} = \rho g_j + \partial_i T_{ij} \tag{2.7.0.1}$$

$$= \rho g_j - \partial_i p + \partial_i\left[2\mu S_{ij} - \frac{2}{3}\mu S_{mm}\delta_{ij} + \mu_v S_{mm}\delta_{ij}\right] \tag{2.7.0.2}$$

$$= \rho g_j - \partial_i p + \partial_i\left[\mu(\partial_i u_j + \partial_j u_i) + \left(\mu_v - \frac{2}{3}\mu\right)\partial_m u_m \delta_{ij}\right] \tag{2.7.0.3}$$

Eq. (2.7.0.3) is called the *Navier-Stokes momentum equation* or simply the Navier-Stokes equation. When the temperature differences are small within the flow, μ and μ_v can be regarded as locally constant, which allows us to write

$$\rho\frac{Du_j}{Dt} = \rho g_j - \partial_i p + \mu\partial_i^2 u_j + \mu\partial_j\partial_i u_i + \left(\mu_v - \frac{2}{3}\mu\right)\partial_i\partial_m u_m \delta_{ij} \tag{2.7.0.4}$$

$$= \rho g_j - \partial_i p + \mu\partial_i^2 u_j + \left(\mu_v + \frac{1}{3}\mu\right)\partial_j\partial_m u_m \tag{2.7.0.5}$$

This equation applies to compressible flow. For incompressible fluids $S_{mm} = 0$, so

$$\rho\frac{Du_j}{Dt} = \rho g_j - \partial_i p + \mu\partial_i^2 u_j \tag{2.7.0.6}$$

Or in vector notation

$$\rho\frac{D\mathbf{u}}{Dt} = \rho\mathbf{g} - \nabla p + \mu\nabla^2\mathbf{u} \tag{2.7.0.7}$$

This is the Navier-Stokes equation for *incompressible, Newtonian fluids.*

Note that the viscous term is related to the vorticity ω in the following way

$$\mu\nabla^2\mathbf{u} = -\mu\nabla \times \omega \tag{2.7.0.8}$$

For inviscid flows, this term drops out. The resulting Navier-Stokes equation is called the *Euler equation*

$$\rho\frac{D\mathbf{u}}{Dt} = \rho\mathbf{g} - \nabla p \tag{2.7.0.9}$$

3 Boundary Conditions

The following sections include some examples of boundary conditions that can be used to solve the Navier-Stokes equation in various contexts.

3.1 Conservation of Mass Boundary Condition

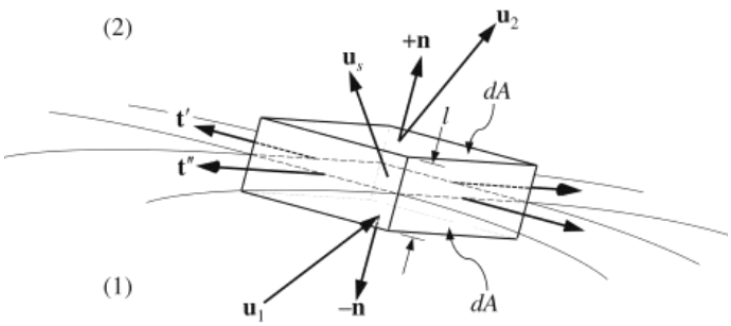


Figure 4: A rectangular control volume at the interface between two immiscible fluids (or a fluid and a solid). The control volume is moving with velocity $\mathbf{u}_s$ and the two tangent vectors to the interface surface are $\mathbf{t}'$ and $\mathbf{t}''$. $+\mathbf{n}$ and $-\mathbf{n}$ are the normal vectors pointing into medium 2 and medium 1 respectively. $\mathbf{u}_1$ and $\mathbf{u}_2$ are the velocities of the material surfaces in the two media.

Consider a control volume at the interace between two immiscible fluids as shown in fig. 4. We can apply eq. (2.1.0.8) for the conservation of mass in an arbitrary control volume to get

$$\dot{m}_s = \rho_1(\mathbf{u}_1 - \mathbf{u}_s) \cdot \mathbf{n} = \rho_2(\mathbf{u}_2 - \mathbf{u}_s) \cdot \mathbf{n} \tag{3.1.0.1}$$

Note that the sign convention chosen for $\dot{m}_s$ dictates whether $+\mathbf{n}$ or $-\mathbf{n}$ should be used for the normal vector. Some common cases are:

1. If (1) is immiscible with (2) there is no mass flowing across the boundary, hence $\dot{m}_s = 0$ and we get $\mathbf{u}_1 \cdot \mathbf{n} = \mathbf{u}_2 \cdot \mathbf{n}$.
2. If (1) is a solid that is not dissolving, ablating, sublimating or otherwise exchanging material at the interface, then $\dot{m}_s = 0$ and $\mathbf{u}_1 = \mathbf{u}_s$ so we get $\mathbf{u}_2 \cdot \mathbf{n} = \mathbf{u}_s \cdot \mathbf{n}$.
3. If the solid is also stationary, we get $\mathbf{u}_2 \cdot \mathbf{n} = 0$

3.2 Constant Surface Tension Boundary Condition

The boundary condition for surface tension can be derived from thermodynamic considerations. First recall that the Helmholtz free energy is defined as

$$F = U - TS \tag{3.2.0.1}$$

Where U is the internal energy of the system, T is the thermodynamical temperature and S is the entropy. To find the Helmholtz free energy per unit mass, we replace U and S by their per unit mass equivalents

$$f = e - Ts \tag{3.2.0.2}$$

Now consider an interface with area A that separates two fluids (1) and (2), with a surface tension coefficient σ. The surface tension coefficient corresponds to the free Helmholtz energy per unit area stored in the interface. Then the total free Helmholtz energy of the system is

$$F = \rho_1 V_1 f_1 + \rho_2 V_2 f_2 + \sigma A \tag{3.2.0.3}$$

The sign of σ is physically meaningful. Recall that nature tends to minimize the Helmholtz free energy.

- If $\sigma > 0$, the two media are immiscible and F will be at a local minimum when A is small, so the interface surface area will tend to decrease over time.
- If $\sigma < 0$, the two media are miscible and the minimum of F occurs when A is large, so the interface surface area will tend to increase until the fluids are completely mixed and the spacing between the folds of the interface is on the order of the molecular distances in the mixture.

Locally, the part of the interface surface that is bounded by some curve C can be seen as a half-spheroid with two principal radii of curvature R_1 and R_2, see fig. 5.

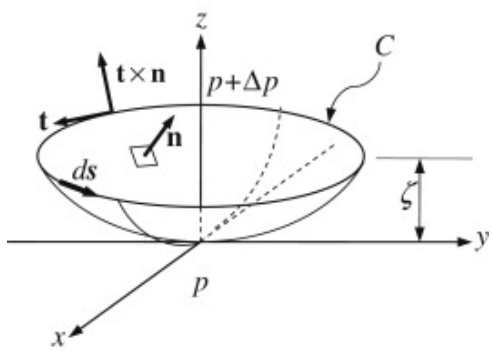


Figure 5: A local model of the interface surface.

We are interested in the equilibrium shape in the case where $\sigma > 0$. In this case, the shape will be dictated by the pressure difference Δp between the lower and upper region in the figure, and the shape will be described by some function η of the following form

$$\eta(x, y, z) = z - h(x, y) = 0 \tag{3.2.0.4}$$

Now choose the coordinate system such that $h(\mathbf{0}) = \partial_i h(\mathbf{0}) = 0$ and such that the x- and y-directions are the direction along which the principal axes curvature lie along the coordinate axes (meaning R_1 and R_2 are found in the xz- and yz-planes). In that case, the shape of the interface is given by

$$\eta(x, y, z) = z\left(\frac{x^2}{2R_1}\right) - \left(\frac{y^2}{2R_2}\right) = 0 \tag{3.2.0.5}$$

3.2.1 Balance of Forces Calculation

If we want to understand how Δp relates to the curvature R_1 and R_2 when the pressure forces are balanced, we will need to perform some detailed calculations. We will consider the limit where the interface area enclosed by C approaches 0.

First, we need to determine the net pressure force $\mathbf{F}_p$ on the interface surface A. The pressure force can be computed via the following surface integral

$$\mathbf{F}_p = -\int_A \Delta p \mathbf{n} dA \tag{3.2.1.1}$$

The minus sign is because we have chosen $\mathbf{n}$ to be the outward normal, and we want a higher pressure above the interface ($\Delta p > 0$) to lead to a downwards pressure force. See fig. 5.

Finding $\mathbf{n}$ is simple

$$\mathbf{n} = \frac{\nabla \eta}{|\nabla \eta|} = \frac{(-x/R_1, -y/R_2, 1)}{\sqrt{(x/R_1)^2 + (y/R_2)^2 + 1}} \tag{3.2.1.2}$$

The area element is

$$dA = \sqrt{1 + (\partial_x \eta)^2 + (\partial_y \eta)^2} dxdy = \sqrt{1 + (x/R_1)^2 + (y/R_2)^2} dxdy \tag{3.2.1.3}$$

We are now ready to perform the integral. In equilibrium, Δp is constant and can be taken outside of the integral

$$\mathbf{F}_p = -\Delta p \int_{-\sqrt{2R_1\xi}}^{+\sqrt{2R_1\xi}} \left[\int_{-\sqrt{2R_2\xi - x^2 R_2/R_1}}^{+\sqrt{2R_2\xi - x^2 R_2/R_1}} (-x/R_1, -y/R_2, 1) dy \right] dx \tag{3.2.1.4}$$

The limits of integration arise from the parametrization of the half-spheroid. The z-component can be evaluated relatively easily

$$(\mathbf{F}_p)_z = -\pi \Delta p \sqrt{2R_1\xi} \sqrt{2R_2\xi} \tag{3.2.1.5}$$

The integrals for the other components are odd integrals with symmetrical limits, so they are zero.

The surface tension force $\mathbf{F}_{st}$ acting on the curve C can be found with the line integral

$$\mathbf{F}_{st} = \sigma \oint_C \mathbf{t} \times \mathbf{n} ds \tag{3.2.1.6}$$

The tangent vector $\mathbf{t}$ to C is

$$\mathbf{t} = -\frac{(1, dy/dx, 0)}{\sqrt{1 + (dy/dx)^2}} \tag{3.2.1.7}$$

And the line element is

$$ds = \sqrt{1 + (dy/dx)^2} dx \tag{3.2.1.8}$$

By performing the cross product and inserting the expression for ds, it is possible to show that

$$\mathbf{t} \times \mathbf{n} ds = \frac{R_2/y)}{sqrt1 + (dy/dx)^2} \left(\frac{x}{R_1}, \frac{y}{R_2}, \frac{x^2}{R_1^2} + \frac{y^2}{R_2^2} \right) dx \tag{3.2.1.9}$$

$$\approx \frac{R_2}{y} \left(\frac{x}{R_1}, \frac{y}{R_2}, \frac{x^2}{R_1^2} + \frac{y^2}{R_2^2} \right) dx \tag{3.2.1.10}$$

The approximation holds for $x/R_1, y/R_2 \ll 1$. We can eliminate y using the equation for the boundary curve

$$\xi = (x^2/2R_1) - (y^2/2R_2), \quad (\xi = \text{const}) \tag{3.2.1.11}$$

Doing so leads to the following integral for the z-component (the x- and y-components are both zero due to the symmetry of the integration path)

$$(\mathbf{F}_{st})_z = 4\sigma \int_0^{\sqrt{2R-1\xi}} \frac{R-2}{\sqrt{2R_2\xi - (R_2/R_1)x^2}} \left[2\xi + \frac{x^2}{R_1}\left(\frac{1}{R_1} - \frac{1}{R_2}\right)\right] dx \tag{3.2.1.12}$$

The factor of 4 is because the integral with these limits only covers a quarter of the full integration path shown in fig. 5. Performing this integral gives

$$(\mathbf{F}_{st})_z = \pi\sigma\sqrt{2R_1\xi}\sqrt{2R_2\xi}\left(\frac{1}{R_1} + \frac{1}{R_2}\right) \tag{3.2.1.13}$$

We are almost done now. Pressure equilibrium requires the net pressure force and net surface tension force to cancel

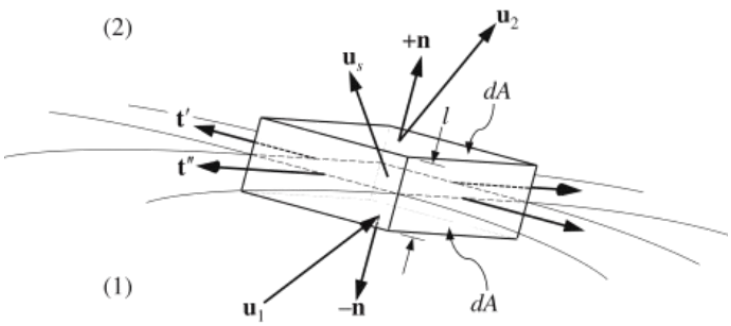
$$\mathbf{F}_p + \mathbf{F}_{st} = 0 \tag{3.2.1.14}$$

Which implies that

$$\Delta p = \sigma\left(\frac{1}{R_1} + \frac{1}{R_2}\right) \tag{3.2.1.15}$$

3.3 Conservation of Momentum Boundary Condition

Recall fig. 4.



If we write down the conservation of momentum along the normal direction $\mathbf{n}$ and use eq. (3.2.1.15), we get

$$\dot{m}_s(\mathbf{u}_2 - \mathbf{u}_1)\cdot\mathbf{n} = -\Delta p + ((n_i\tau_{ij})_2 - (n_i\tau_{ij})_1) + \sigma\left(\frac{1}{R'} + \frac{1}{R''}\right) \tag{3.3.0.1}$$

Where τ_{ij} is the viscous stress tensor (2.6.1.6) and R' and R'' are the principal radii of curvature that lie along the principal directions of curvature $\mathbf{t}'$ and $\mathbf{t}''$. When $\dot{m}_s = 0$ and the fluid is inviscid, or when both fluids are stationary, this reduces to the pressure differnece (3.2.1.15).

3.3.1 The No-Slip Condition

It is not possible to ascertain the requirements on the tangential components of the fluid velocities from the equations of motion. However, the following condition has been experimentally verified and is accepted for most ordinary fluids

$$\mathbf{u}_1 \cdot \mathbf{t}' = \mathbf{u}_2 \cdot \mathbf{t}', \quad \mathbf{u}_1 \cdot \mathbf{t}'' = \mathbf{u}_2 \cdot \mathbf{t}'' \tag{3.3.1.1}$$

This is called the *no-slip condition* and it states that the tangential velocity components must match at the interface. For the common case of a viscous fluid (2) moving with respect to an impermeable solid (1), eqs. (3.3.0.1) and (3.3.1.1) reduce to

$$\mathbf{u}_2 = \mathbf{u}_1 \tag{3.3.1.2}$$

At the interface.

3.3.2 Control Volume Boundary Conditions

For the control volume in fig. 4, the following boundary conditions apply

$$((n_i\tau_{ij})_2 - (n_i\tau_{ij})_1)t'_j + (\partial_j\sigma)t'_j = ((n_i\tau_{ij})_2 - (n_i\tau_{ij})_1)t''_j + (\partial_j\sigma)t''_j = 0 \tag{3.3.2.1}$$

3.4 Conservation of Energy Boundary Conditions

The conservation of energy boundary condition can be found by considering the internal and kinetic energy of the fluids, the work done by body and surface forces, as well as the heat flux across the interface. By accounting for these factors, it is possible to arrive at

$$\dot{m}_s \left[\left(h + \frac{1}{2}|\mathbf{u}|^2 \right)_2 - \left(h + \frac{1}{2}|\mathbf{u}|^2 \right)_1 \right] = -\kappa \left[(\nabla T)_2 - (\nabla T)_1 \right] \cdot \mathbf{n} \tag{3.4.0.1}$$

Where h is the heat transfer coefficient and κ is the thermal conductivity across the interface. The energy equivalent of the no-slip condition is

$$T_1 = T_2 \tag{3.4.0.2}$$

Which forbids temperature jumps at the boundary.

4 Gravity Waves (no, not the kind you're thinking of)

5 Mathematical Interludes